

Drew McFarland

Service Designer | USAF Veteran | Active Secret Clearance

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EXPERIENCE

Rise8, Inc.

May 2025 – Present

Senior Service Designer

- Reshaped the platform roadmap based on stakeholder research that pinpointed where new DoD programs were getting stuck during onboarding, shifting priority toward the capabilities they needed to reach first deployment
- Redesigned the tenant onboarding journey from provisioning through first deployment, turning a high-touch engineering-led process into a repeatable one with reusable artifacts that new tenant teams now run themselves

USAF – Kessel Run

Apr 2022 – May 2025

Design Operations Lead

- Grew daily active users 300% for a flight scheduling application by mapping the full service experience and working with military leadership to clear the operational roadblocks holding it back
- Used service blueprints to align 8 delivery teams around operator needs, keeping engineering effort on high-impact work instead of features nobody asked for
- Built accessibility standards (Section 508), research templates, and design playbooks adopted across 5 programs that kept running after I moved on

Product Designer

May 2017 – Apr 2022

- Cut maintenance initiation time 20% for a pilot debriefing app used across multiple airframes and branches by leading UX from research through delivery
- Mapped developer journeys on a Platform-as-a-Service, surfaced 5 key friction points, and drove changes that increased platform adoption roughly 40%
- Grew the application's footprint from 2 commands to 6 by building relationships with key advocates and running hands-on workshops with each new unit to show fit before pushing for rollout

DrewUX

Jun 2016 – Present

Service Design Consultant

- Took a defense tech startup from concept to launch: ran user research, built service blueprints, and shaped the pitch that landed them a NYC local government contract and an SBIR grant
- Led discovery for a DoD data analysis startup and turned research into a value story that contributed to a \$150K Stage 1 SBIR award

EDUCATION

M.S. Human-Computer Interaction Iowa State University

B.S. IT Project Management Western Governors University